

Location Note: The Sub-Level Surge Siphon (the "Overflow")

1. The Vibe (The Liminal Rathole)

- **The Architecture:** It looks like the giant tunnel construction and the circular skylight images you provided. A colossal, curved concrete tunnel. Every hundred feet, massive circular grates in the ceiling let in columns of sickly, pale green industrial light from the factory levels far above.
- **The Floor:** It is flooded with ankle-deep, slow-moving runoff. It's not thick sludge; it is dark, freezing, and highly reflective.
- **The Sound (The Colossal Fan):** At the far end of the tunnel sits a massive, multi-story extraction fan (like your second reference image). It is running at a very low RPM. It doesn't roar; it produces a deep, rhythmic, subsonic *thud... thud... thud...* that vibrates right in Sa's chest. It sounds like a dying mechanical heartbeat.

2. The Contrast (The "Dirty Secret")

The contrast you provided with the flowers in the ancient aqueduct is a genius visual anchor. We translate that into the sci-fi setting:

- The **Cryo-Case** isn't buried in trash. It is sitting perfectly in the center of one of those circular columns of green light, resting in the shallow, dark water.
- Its pristine, high-tech white casing and pulsing amber Faction-A beacon look entirely alien against the brutalist, rusted concrete and the cold municipal runoff. It looks exactly like what it is: a highly sensitive, illegal secret dumped in the gutter.

The Sub-Level Surge Siphon (the "Overflow") fits the logic of Abyss City perfectly, provided the engineering constraints of a submarine environment are respected. At a depth of 500 to 700 feet, you are dealing with roughly 220 to 310 PSI of external pressure. This makes the "liminal rathole" design not just an aesthetic choice, but a structural necessity.

Design Audit: Why the "Overflow" Works

- **Structural Geometry:** The circular, TBM-style (Tunnel Boring Machine) architecture in your references is the most logical shape for a deep-sea environment. Curved surfaces distribute external pressure more evenly than flat walls. In the "butthole" of the city, using older, reinforced concrete bores for secondary drainage is a realistic way to save on expensive titanium-glass alloys.
- **The "Bilge" Concept:** Every submarine vessel or habitat has a bilge—a low point where condensation, micro-leaks, and chemical runoff inevitably pool. The "Overflow" acts as the city's bilge. It's the "rathole" because it's the last stop for waste before it's compressed and pumped out into the crushing pressure of the deep.
- **The Audio-Visual Loop:** The massive, slow-moving fan is a life-support requirement. In a submarine city, air is a recycled commodity. A fan that size moving "dead air" (CO₂-heavy) toward the scrubbers creates that subsonic *thud* that reinforces the feeling of being trapped in a giant, breathing machine.